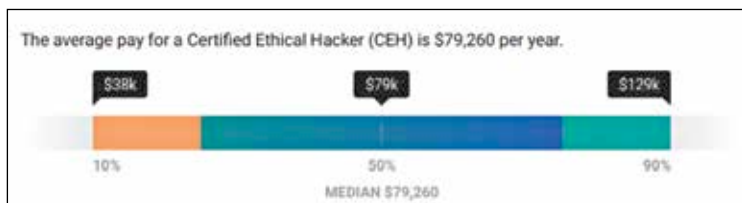


increasing demand for cyber-security experts. Breaches are becoming more significant than ever, and people are getting more and more concerned about their privacy and their data. And this where ethical hackers come in.

Prerequisites

An ethical hacker is expected to be fluent in database handling, operating systems, networks and cryptography. An ethical hacker should be able to think creatively because there is no lack of black hat hackers who continuously come up with clever ways to circumvent security measures. However, this keeps the job interesting.



Pay scales for ethical hackers

Career path

According to Payscale, the salary of certified ethical hackers averages out to just under \$80k per annum.

While certifications are not the sole touchstone of one's abilities, they sure do help in proving your knowledge and skills to employers. A certificate like Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH) will do you great help even if you have insufficient industry experience. Apart from CEH, there are a few other noteworthy certifications like:

- SANS GIAC certification
- Certified Vulnerability Assessor (CVA)
- Certified Professional Ethical Hacker (CPEN)
- Certified Penetration Testing Engineer (CPTE)

After attaining the coveted CEH v10, the following job profiles are available to an ethical hacker:

- Information Security Analyst
- Security Analyst
- Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH)
- Ethical Hacker